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Inclusivity of entrepreneurship education on entrepreneurial attitude among young community: evidence from India

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Abstract

Purpose – In India, many promotional policies and educational institutions have focused on entrepreneurship education (EE) for the development of future entrepreneurs. Through the survey from a region of Uttar Pradesh (UP), India, this paper aims to study the young community's entrepreneurial attitude (EA) towards entrepreneurship.

Design/methodology/approach – The data was collected from a young community of various universities and colleges in different regions of UP, India to find out that "Does the EE help in developing a positive EA among young community towards entrepreneurship". Firstly, 23 interviews have been conducted to explore about EE and EA. Further data was collected from 341 respondents through a structured questionnaire and undertaken done with the descriptive analysis: exploratory factor analysis and multiple regression method to explore the result of this study.

Findings – After the analysis, it was found that EE played an important role in developing EA of the young community towards entrepreneurship. All the coefficients in the regression model are positive, which means that all the factors of EE (awareness, enterprise knowledge and practical skills) have a positive impact on EA (affective, cognitive and behavioural).

Practical implications – This study provides a futuristic direction to various academic institutes and government organizations on how they prepare future entrepreneurs by inculcating EA among them. Creative minds generate innovative products and services, create jobs, alleviate poverty and maintain the GDP of a nation.

Originality/value – To the best of the authors' knowledge, this is the first study to identify the relationship between EE and EA with the help of qualitative and quantitative analyses.

Keywords Entrepreneurship, India, Entrepreneurship education, Entrepreneurial attitude, Young community

Paper type Research paper

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While entrepreneurship classes are designed to give budding entrepreneurs the tools to turn a new idea into reality, their value may be even greater than that: I think it gives all young

community the ability to view their careers and opportunities in a different light. It's so important that the benefits of an entrepreneurial focused education are available to all young community and not just those planning on entering the start-up world. (John Dearborn President, JumpStart Inc.)

1. Introduction

Entrepreneurship plays an important role in the stabilization of economic activities in any country (Ahmed *et al.*, 2017; Ilonen *et al.*, 2018; Ratten, 2019). It is conventionally explained as initiating and running an enterprise, mainly beginning as a small enterprise, by utilizing the entrepreneurial skills and abilities and offering the products and services to the society based on innovative ideas, and the individuals who do all these activities are recognized as "entrepreneurs". In India, the micro-, small- and medium-sized enterprises are majorly contributing to the GDP of the country as well as are responsible for the generation of the largest share of employment after agriculture (Agarwal and Lenka, 2018; Dana, 2000; Durán-Sánchez *et al.*, 2019). So, to increase the number of enterprises, we require potential entrepreneurs who can bear all the risks and put their innovative and creative efforts to start an enterprise. For developing entrepreneurs, firstly, we need to cultivate the minds of individuals in terms of developing the entrepreneurial attitude (EA) or to provide wings to their dreams so that they are able to move in a right direction, do the right work and can bring entrepreneurial ideas into real platforms (Kassean *et al.*, 2015). In India, government puts many efforts to attract the future entrepreneurs to participate in start-up initiatives. The Government of India facilitated various schemes and policies to encourage the young community to initiate their own enterprises. Indian economy is increasing speedily as well as becoming a promising center for entrepreneurship.

1.1 Scope of the study

Indian economy is midst in the entrepreneurial journey, and India emerges as the most exciting entrepreneurial society in the world. In India, entrepreneurship education (EE) is still in its nascent stage. EE in various institutes is offered as a discipline or as a part of a wider syllabus. But, the question emerges as whether these initiatives are enough to thrust entrepreneurship up to the scale that India needed (Sharma, 2019). The question arises now that: *Why EE is necessary*? EE strengthens the entrepreneurial environment as the culture and value of experiential learning inculcates the EA and skills in the young community, which help them in their entrepreneurial journey. The main objectives of EE are to understand the concept and the aspects of EE, develop a more entrepreneurial mindset and understand the process of operating the enterprise commendably. A psychological or sociological approach and also the theory of McClelland (1961) explain the understanding of individual as an entrepreneurial character that configures the EA in a specific environment. Researchers analyse the different characteristics of the entrepreneurial action based on EA's to achieve its goal and skills. The intention to become an entrepreneur depends on EA (Ajzen, 1991); the more the intensity towards the development of EA, the higher the possibility of the individual to adopt entrepreneur-like behaviour (Arias-Aranda and Bustinza-Sánchez, 2009; Robinson *et al.*, 1991).

The Government of India has promoted various schemes and policies to bring out the association between education and entrepreneurs and to support the entrepreneurial ecosystem (Nair, 2018). Make in India, Startup India, Skill India, etc., are the few initiatives that make effort to transform the economy of India into entrepreneurial from managerial one (Sharma, 2019). However, many efforts have been made in this field, but yet more sustained and firm efforts are needed to promote EE. In India, the Ministry of Skill Development and

Entrepreneurship proposed various schemes to educate and promote the young community in entrepreneurial activities. EE in India will be assimilated into the curriculum in 3,000 colleges, imparted in the form of online learning courses through Massively Open Online Courses (MOOCs) and around 50 nodal entrepreneurship hubs (E-hubs) established across all states for the existing and potential entrepreneurs. To provide support to young or nascent entrepreneurs, the government has prepared a platform based on Web and mobile that connects the entire entrepreneurial ecosystem where the members can access content online, get information about government services, create networks and get advice from mentors on entrepreneurial activities. The initiation of a new incubator will be encouraged to support young entrepreneurs and their entrepreneurial activities in innovative and cutting-edge technology areas will be associated with government initiatives such as the Atal Innovation Mission and Self Employment Talent Utilisation scheme (Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, 2019). Definitely, the EE strengthens the entrepreneurial environment by developing and generating entrepreneurial mindsets and creates future entrepreneurial leaders with entrepreneurial skills to solve complex and integrated problems and support the entrepreneurial ecosystem. According to the ideation of Schumpeter (1934), Kirzner (1973) and Casson (1982), entrepreneurship is closely connected to creation and innovation; thus, in developing countries, EE will emphasize on raising the innovation activities by supporting the young/nascent entrepreneurs with advance cutting-age technologies as the development of any country is always associated with the innovation potential residing in advanced and diverse industrial sectors (Ramadani and Gerguri, 2011; Ramadani *et al.*, 2013). Thus, efforts are being undertaken by the government, academia and researchers in encouraging EE to strengthen the EA among the young community if the emerging countries want to resolve the issues of unemployment, poverty, gender inequality, etc.

1.2 Objective of the study

Many promotional policies and educational institutions have focused on the EE for develop the future aspirants of India. Through a survey from a region of Uttar Pradesh (UP), India, this study tries to determine the impact of EE on EA of the young community. The young community produces future entrepreneurs of India who will be responsible for the generation of employment through enterprises and would contribute in innovation and creation activities. Hence, from the above discussion, the main aims of this study are as follows:

- construction and validation of a scale of EE and EA with the help of a qualitative approach;
- identification of factors associated with EE and EA with the help of an exploratory factor analysis; and
- identification of the relationship between the EE and EA of the young community in the Indian context.

After a brief introduction and the scope and objectives of this study, the relevant literature is reviewed along with raising the research question; then, the methodology is discussed, followed by the final results and discussion and lastly the conclusion is stated with implications and future scope of the study.

2. Literature review

In 1700 AD, the term "entrepreneur" was addressed for the architects and contractors of public works. The word "entrepreneur" was coined by Richard Cantillon (Hisrich and Ramadani, 2017; Landstrom, 1999). According to him, an entrepreneur is the one who has

the capability of identifying the opportunities and taking risks to achieve the maximum satisfaction from the venture. The entrepreneur is taken from the French verb, "enterprendre", which interprets as "to undertake" (Agarwal and Lenka, 2015). The initiation of an enterprise depends on different parameters such as availability of finance, generation of an idea, infrastructure, market awareness, skills, competencies and the attitude of a person, which is the most important psychological element. The attitude provides the favourable or unfavourable expression of thought towards a person, thing and situation. As defined by a prominent psychologist, Allport (1935) define attitude as, "the most distinctive and indispensable concept in contemporary social psychology". This attitude can be framed or attached with the person's past and present experiences.

Previous studies emphasized that EE is intended to encourage the careers possibility of the young community towards entrepreneurship through developing EA (Ede *et al.*, 1998; Kassean *et al.*, 2015; Peterman and Kennedy, 2003). To be effective, scholars argued that action must be focused in EE and separate from conventional characteristics such as the writing of business plans (Dana, 2001). A pioneering approach is required to integrate the academia and real-world through live cases, role plays, etc. (Hörnqvist and Leffler, 2014; Kuratko, 2006). Lent *et al.* (1994) used a well-established theoretical foundation to research the connections between educational experiences and the motivational mechanisms underlying the movement of young community toward entrepreneurial behaviour as social cognitive career theory (SCCT). SCCT is a built-up profession hypothesis that has been applied in numerous spaces to clarify the inspirational process underlying individual's behaviour. SCCT is, as its centre, a hypothesis of inspiration that is driven by the three elements of self-efficacy, result desires (for example, identified with work conditions and results) and goal-directed movement. This theory explained that these three factors are critical antecedents of EA and influenced by EE (Boyd and Vozikis, 1994; Byars-Winston and Fouad, 2008; McWhirter *et al.*, 2007; Zhao *et al.*, 2005).

2.1 Entrepreneurship education

Education is considered as the powerful tool to enhance the learning process in a continuous manner (Welsh *et al.*, 2017; Palalic *et al.*, 2020). It brings changes in the thinking process, which are reflected in the individual behaviour and action. EE is defined as the "purposeful intervention by the educator in the life of the learner to impart entrepreneurial qualities and skills to ensure that the learner is able to survive in the business world" (Kgagara, 2011). EE is emerging day by day in India, as it is considered as the most essential force to promote the growth of economy. Having a question as can entrepreneurship be taught (Henry *et al.*, 2005), government and non-government education institutions are provided entrepreneurship learning and knowledge to their young community by inculcating these as elective courses and professional courses. The young community are future entrepreneurs who are considered as drivers for economic growth by establishing new-quality products and services.

In India, government and non-government organizations have taken a proactive approach to facilitate the EE environment throughout the country to accomplish the competencies required in the entrepreneurs for the development of the economy and society. EE and training are highly essential for the initiation of ventures (Arthur and Adom, 2019). Through the education, the transfer of knowledge has been facilitated in terms of entrepreneurial intention, skills, competencies, change in personality and the most important a change in attitude (Kgagara, 2011; Mentoor and Friedrich (2007). Education has emphasized in building the learning capability of learners mainly in increasing their self-confidence and abilities, increase of desire to start and success of enterprise, able to understand the managerial, operational, and financial issues of enterprise, and lastly to learn

more new things for the development and success of an enterprise (Ahmed *et al.*, 2017; Galvão *et al.*, 2018; Henry *et al.*, 2005).

The entrepreneurship has many schools of thoughts explained by Fayolle (2002) as below (Table 1).

The above discussion explored that entrepreneurship is a learning, career, profession, etc. and can therefore be taught as done throughout the world to increase more entrepreneurs (Drucker, 2006; Ilonen *et al.*, 2018; Kgagara, 2011; Kuratko, 2006). Thus, the above discussion raises the following questions:

RQ1. How could EE be evaluated?

RQ2. What are the various factors associated with EE?

2.2 Entrepreneurial attitude

The previous literature emphasized the importance of EA to build-up the entrepreneurial behaviour of an individual (Ajzen, 1991; Fayolle, 2002), and this entrepreneurial attitude is influenced by entrepreneurship education (Fayolle, 2002; Lüthje and Franke, 2003). As stated by Bosma (2013), "EA as attitudes towards entrepreneurship". Attitude is a cognitive process that affects the thinking process of an individual, as if the young community develops the positive attitude towards entrepreneurship, this positivity brings the ability to identify the opportunities to initiate an own business (Ajzen, 1991). Attitude brings changes in personality, skills, knowledge, perception, experience, etc., of an entrepreneur, which makes him/her different from the general population. EA is essential because it expresses the intention of an individual to start an enterprise (Arias-Aranda and Bustinza-Sánchez, 2009; Ayalew and Zeleke, 2018). Attitude is a person's psychological trait, and intention is a person's mental capacity. Thus, the intention has reflected in the entrepreneurial activity of an entrepreneur; therefore, attitude act as a steppingstone in the construction of entrepreneurial behaviour in the young community (Collins *et al.*, 2004). Thus, the above discussion raises the following questions:

RQ3. How could EA be evaluated?

RQ4. What are the various factors associated with EA?

Entrepreneurial model	Explanation
Great person school	An individual has inborn characteristics of entrepreneurial skills and focus on success stories of different entrepreneurs
Psychological characteristics school	The mainly emphasized on the attributes of an entrepreneur such as ethics, responsibility, risk taking, initiatives, etc.
Classical school	An entrepreneur has the capability to innovate, create the new things with the identification and exploration of opportunities
Management school	The proper management tools are applied by an entrepreneur to pursuit the market opportunities and initiate the organization
Leadership school	With the managerial skills, an entrepreneur is having the leadership skills to lead their employees to achieve the goal
Intrapreneurship	An intrapreneur has characteristics of an entrepreneur that help the corporate world to develop in new areas with innovation and creativity

Source: Fayolle (2002)

Table 1. Entrepreneurship's school of thoughts

2.3 Entrepreneurship education and entrepreneurial attitude

Entrepreneurship as a parlance is concerned at national and international levels as policy frameworks and curricula (Palalic *et al.*, 2017). However, many efforts are made to include entrepreneurship in schools, colleges and universities with the aim to nourish EA among the young community/future entrepreneurs. Considering that Western societies in the 21st century are marked by rapid changes that are difficult to predict, one of the education sector's main tasks is to provide young people with the knowledge and skills required to cope up with these changes (Hörnqvist and Leffler, 2014). EE has been encouraging the enterprising people with EA by a supporting culture and a learning environment (Gibb, 1993; Maslowski, 2006). In previous studies, the role of EA has been shown as positive towards the generation of EA among the young community (Ede *et al.*, 1998; Hörnqvist and Leffler, 2014; Kassean *et al.*, 2015; Mentoor and Friedrich, 2007). Nieuwenhuizen and Groenewald (2008) stated in their studies that the young community who participated in entrepreneurial courses has positive attitude towards the initiation of a venture as compared to other who attend different courses. The previous studies have emphasized on the higher education level of entrepreneurs as compared to the general population (Fayolle and Gailly, 2015; Shinnar *et al.*, 2009). Thus, education is considered as an important and promising factor to increase the supply of potential entrepreneurs. However, as stated by Byabashaija and Katono (2011, p. 129), "The effect of general education has been explored but only a few studies have looked at EE, particularly at university and tertiary institution level". It can be concluded that research on the impact of EE on EA of the young community is still limited and the research based on empirical testing is still enduring. Thus, to address this limitation, the current research investigates the effect of EE on EA of the young community. The above discussion raises the following question:

RQ5. Does EE have any impact on EA of the young community?

3. Research methodology

3.1 Questionnaire and data collection procedure

After the identification of research problems, the research design has been constructed to collect the data from various universities. For this study, data is firstly collected with the help of an interview approach from 23 respondents of the young community belonging to different colleges and universities of UP, India, who have studied at the master's level. Master level is considered because the intention to become an entrepreneur is very strongly present in such individuals. The reason for considering the qualitative research is that it requires a smaller sample size and a sample size of 23 is adequate to analyse the problems mentioned in previous studies (Agarwal and Lenka, 2016, 2017; Aramand, 2012; Bertaux and Crable, 2007; Montague, 2017). Although the sample size is small, the researchers are able to spend more time with each respondent and go into a deeper detail and understanding (Dhaliwal, 2000). In the qualitative research, the sample size was sufficiently large to be accurate and yet small enough to reflect the perspective of each respondent accurately (Montague, 2017). Researchers find during the semi-structured interview process that including more respondents does not result in additional details, often called saturation (Glaser and Strauss, 1967). The authors prepare some interview questions (Appendix 1) to probe and get more information from the respondents. The respondents were approached through convenience sampling from April 2019 to June 2019. The interview approach is one of the methods of qualitative approach, emphasized on an in-depth understanding of behaviour of respondents to explore and elucidate a certain phenomenon by the interpretation of data non-statistically (Burns, 1999; Dana and Dana, 2005; Lenka and

Agarwal, 2017). Data are collected through face-to-face interviews from respondents who are ready to give interviews about the importance and association of EE and EA. These respondents are already having EE in their course curriculum and is also one of the reasons for their selection by researchers. The statements quoted by the respondents are mentioned in Table 3, and the items are generated, refined and further purified with the help of nine experts' views. The researchers quoted only those statements from the whole interview that seems important and relevant to this study. R1–R23 are the respondents who give the interview to conduct this study. The names of the respondents are kept confidential to maintain their anonymity with their consent. The details of expert's profile are listed in Table 2. The expert method is a quick and easy method and has been used as a pretesting method to identify the credibility of the content (Presser and Blair, 1994; Olson, 2010).

3.2 Reliability and validity of the interview approach

Burns (1999, p. 118) stated that," Interviews are a popular and widely used means of collecting qualitative data". The inquirer always tries to obtain special kind of information, i.e. what is there in the minds of respondents? It is also necessary to check the reliability and validity of data to check the quality, acceptability and credibility of the research.

Firstly, the validity of this study is measured with the content validity: the questions for the semi-structure interview are properly discussed and prepared after the experts' opinion and unclear and obscure questions are revised or removed. Secondly, with internal validity, triangulation and member check methods are used; in the triangulation method, the author collects data from different sources and techniques such as from discussion by faculty and classroom observations; in the member check method, the content prepared by the researchers is given back to the respondents to check whether the data which they stated during the interview is correct or not. External validity is also measured by recording the responses from different respondents and observing the same kind of information. In this way, the credibility and truthfulness of the information can be documented and made acceptable for this study. Internal and external reliability was measured. The interviews were properly recorded and re-analysed by the different researchers of this study. The data is again collected in next two months (July–August, 2019) by co-authors from the same respondents by using the same open-ended questions (Appendix 1) and adopting different

SN	Profession	Type of organization	Qualification	Experience	Position	Age (years)
1	Education	Government	PhD	20	Professor	52
2	Education	Private	PhD	27	Professor, Director	59
3	Entrepreneur	Private – service	Graduate	15	Owner	42
4	Entrepreneur	Private – knitting and Tailoring	Postgraduate	21	Owner	61
5	Entrepreneur	Private – manufacturing	Diploma	9	Owner	38
6	Education	Government	PhD	11	Associate Professor	36
7	Education	Government	PhD	16	Associate Professor, Entrepreneurship cell coordinator	46
8	Entrepreneur	Private – manufacturing	Engineer	15	Owner	43
9	Entrepreneur	Private – handicraft	Diploma	5	Owner	29

Source: Authors

Table 2. Expert's profile

methods such as classroom observations and discussion with their faculty to check whether the procedure, information and findings are reliable or not.

Thus, with the help of experts' opinions, the items from Table 3 are framed with category and selected to prepare the preliminary questionnaire for EE and EA (Tables 4 and 5) for further analysis procedure.

Thus, a preliminary questionnaire was organized comprising 23 items of EE and 24 items of EA, and it was communicated to 49 respondents for pilot testing through convenience sampling.

3.3 Pilot testing

Pilot testing is a preliminary study to test the reliability of the questionnaire on few respondents from the population. For this study, 49 responses were collected from the young community studying entrepreneurship-related subjects to check the reliability and improve the items of the questionnaire of EE and EA. From the data analysis through SPSS 19, it is analysed that the values of Cronbach's alpha for the 23 items of EE and 24 items of EA are 0.67 and 0.73, respectively. If the value of Cronbach's alpha is equal to or above 0.6, then the value is considered reliable (Hair *et al.*, 2015; Nunnally *et al.*, 1967). Thus, all the items in the questionnaire are essential, reliable and thus retained for further analysis.

3.4 Data collection procedure

After confirmation of the reliability of the questionnaire, the actual survey was carried out for further collection of data from the rest of the respondents. The data was collected during October–December 2019 from the respondents of different educational institutions from Mathura, Agra, Aligarh and Moradabad regions of UP, India. The young community was approached by convenience sampling, who willingly provide actual view about their EA towards entrepreneurship. The 341 respondents were considered to collect the data on a five-point Likert scale (1 = strongly disagree to 5 = strongly agree) to know about their EA. *Does really EE generate the EA towards entrepreneurship or not, is the main objective of this study*. A total of 273 responses were considered for this study and 80.05% are adequate for further investigation compared to Allen and Babbie (2008) who stated that 50% responses are valid for analysis and provide the appropriate result.

3.5 Reliability testing of the questionnaire

To investigate the reliability of the questionnaire by considering total respondents, internal consistency was used as a reliable instrument that provided consistent results (Hair *et al.*, 2015; Nunnally *et al.*, 1967). The reliability was found less than 0.6 for both the groups; therefore, after analysis and consultation with our experts, four items from EE and three items from EA were removed from further analysis. After this activity, the value of Cronbach's alpha for EE is 0.721 and 0.812 for EA, showing improvement and reliability in terms of internal consistency as Malhotra (2002) and Hair *et al.* (2015) stated that Cronbach's alpha value should be equal to or above than 0.67, which demonstrated the good reliability and good internal consistency of the instrument and its validity for further analysis.

Respondents	Important statements (observations from interview)
F-R1	"For idea generation, EE are very helpful as it provides the blueprint of your entrepreneurial journey"
M-R2	"During the study of EE, we aware about various entrepreneurial success stories which motivates and strengthen the desire to becoming an entrepreneur"
M-R3	"EE also guide us various channels that how we initiate grow and develop the small enterprise"
M-R4	"The main thing in entrepreneurship is idea generation. We actually think a lot and also confused whether our idea is viable in market or not. EE provides the information about the various channels for the opportunity identification"
F-R5	"As a female, it is difficult to think or discuss with family members about the own enterprise. But because of EE we aware about the challenges faced by successful women entrepreneurs and importance of independent, self-worth and empowerment through enterprise"
M-R6	"Under the EE various workshops provided the knowledge about the market exploitation and utilization"
F-R7	"In India government initiated lots of funding to promote entrepreneurship. Through EE we got the knowledge about the schemes as well as funding agencies such as banks, NGOs etc."
F-R8	"EE gives the insight about the need of market. It understands the concept of idea, opportunity and new product and services"
M-R9	"We visited to trade fair at Delhi under this subject and interact with many small entrepreneurs and get information about their journey of creation of their enterprises"
M-R10	"EE has consisted of various modules which get aware about the entrepreneurial culture, motivation, and barriers related to enterprise"
M-R11	"When we were going into the field for one assignment related to EE, get interact with customers and their needs, we surprised to know that still they are not getting things which they need. In this digital scenario we always perceive that everything is available"
M-R12	"EE gives knowledge about the importance of networking in enterprise development"
M-R13	"Why entrepreneurship different from business? this confusion viper away through valuable insights given by our faculty"
F-R14	"To become entrepreneur is not difficult but challenging tasks. We understand that entrepreneurs are made not born"
F-R15	"Importance of networking is necessary in entrepreneurial journey, but it also depends on entrepreneur's interpersonal skills"
M-R16	"EE gives new definition and prospects if anyone interested in supply chain management. Nowadays everyone wants to explore this field because of growth of e-commerce"
M-R17	"Entrepreneur is like an actor who with his innovative and creative skills creates the own market. Through EE, we get the opportunity to be developed as entrepreneurial personality"
M-R18	"EE helps us to develop the entrepreneurial competencies helpful in manage the entrepreneurial activities"
M-R19	"The education provides a different way to think about the things such new product or services or any problem. Also teach us to take risk, without this attribute, difficult to survive in this competitive world"
M-R20	"EE helpful to clear the picture about the entrepreneurial journey of various successful and un-successful entrepreneurs"
M-R21	"This course helps us to develop the entrepreneurial type of abilities, skills and competencies which helpful in corporate world"
F-R22	"From this we actually increase our thinking process to look the problem differently. I now think that if others do why I not"
M-R23	"I think everyone have an idea or some plan which need some direction. This course gives the path to nourish our idea"

(*continued*)

Table 3. Statements of respondents recorded during the interview

Respondents	Important statements (observations from interview)
F-R5	"This course related knowledge provides me opportunity to give the picture of my thinking in the form of idea"
F-R8	"Though this course we learned a lot about writing the business plan, development of business plan and the related schemes and policies"
M-R11	"Competencies, skills or abilities necessary in entrepreneurship field as entrepreneurial competencies and in corporate world as intrapreneurs. This course develops the learning environment to share, utilize and exploit your ideas. Actually, created the madness environment to present solution of every problem is a unique way"

Notes: *F, female respondent; M, male respondent
Source: Authors

Table 3.

SN	Items (EE)*	Category*
1	The EE helps me in enterprise promotion	Awareness
2	The EE helps me in gaining knowledge about enterprise insights	Enterprise knowledge
3	The EE helps me in creation of new enterprises	Awareness
4	The EE helps me in opportunity recognition	Awareness
5	The EE helps me in sense of self-worth and empowerment	Awareness
6	The EE helps me in supply chain management	Practical skills
7	The EE helps me in maintaining interpersonal relationships	Practical skills
8	The EE helps me in financial awareness (loans, funding agencies, etc.)	Awareness
9	The EE helps me in being creative and innovative	Practical skills
10	The EE helps me in risk tasking	Enterprise knowledge
11	The EE helps me in awareness about customer needs and demands	Awareness
12	The EE helps me in enterprise management	Enterprise knowledge
13	The EE helps me in new product development	Practical skills
14	The EE helps me in taking initiatives	Practical skills
15	The EE helps me in decision making	Practical skills
16	The EE helps me in organizing resources	Practical skills
17	The EE helps me in team building	Practical skills
18	The EE helps me in problem-solving	Practical skills
19	The EE helps me in networking with stakeholders	Practical skills
20	The EE helps me in competency development	Enterprise knowledge
21	The EE helps me in idea development	Enterprise knowledge
22	The EE helps me in market awareness	Awareness
23	The EE helps me in awareness about development schemes	Awareness

Note: *All items are considered after taking the experts' opinion
Source: Authors

Table 4.
Items related to EE

4. Exploratory factor analysis

For factor identification for EE and EA empirically, the exploratory factor analysis (EFA) was carried out to calculate the value of the Kaiser–Meyer–Olkin (KMO) index for adequate sample size and suitability of data, and after analysis with 273 respondents, results showed that the values of EE and EA were 0.71 and 0.66, respectively (Malhotra, 2002; Hair *et al.*, 2015). Bartlett's test of sphericity was shown to have statistically significance, and no indication of multicollinearity was found (Table 6 and Table 7) (Hair *et al.*, 2015;

SN	Items (EA)*	Category
1	I feel enthusiastic towards entrepreneurial activities	Affective
2	I learned various lessons from the entrepreneurial journey of entrepreneurs	Behavioural
3	I am trying to improve the decision-making skills through this course	Behavioural
4	I develop the positive feeling through my failures	Affective
5	I am developing the entrepreneurial related competencies by incorporating the lessons of this course	Behavioural
6	I believe that entrepreneurial knowledge is necessary to initiate an enterprise	Cognitive
7	I feel happy to work with innovative friends in entrepreneurial learning environment	Affective
8	I learn the importance of networking for the success of entrepreneurial activities	Cognitive
9	The learning gives the idea of discovering and utilizing the opportunities from market	Behavioural
10	I trust it is necessary to identify own weakness for the entrepreneurial success	Cognitive
11	I give more time to organize and manage the things appropriately	Behavioural
12	I start asking many questions	Behavioural
13	I think that competencies are necessary in this competitive business world.	Cognitive
14	I feel excited when I give or doing any new and unusual things	Affective
15	I believe that various lessons we learn from successful role models.	Cognitive
16	I listen the entrepreneurial journey of many entrepreneurs to know about their challenges.	Behavioural
17	I think that EE energize your curiosity habit	Cognitive
18	I believe that every idea has unique opportunities or prospects	Cognitive
19	When my answer appreciates by everyone, it develops the sense of accomplishment to me	Affective
20	I feel to be unique to looking the problem in different ways	Affective
21	I feel happy that my learning and hard work resulted in my activities	Affective
22	I try to never miss any lecture of this course	Behavioural
23	My interest towards entrepreneurship strengthen by EE	Cognitive
24	I actively participate and organize the entrepreneurial activities	Behavioural

Note: *All items are considered after taking the experts' opinion
Source: Authors

Table 5. Items related to EA

Statistics	Value
EE	
Cronbach's alpha	0.721
No. of items	19
KMO (measures of sampling adequacy)	0.71
Barlett's test of sphericity	
Chi-square	1292.03
Degree of freedom	42.00
Significance	0.000

Table 6. Reliability and KMO statistics of EE

Malhotra, 2002). Then, factors of EE and EA have been explored by conducting EFA by using the principal component method with varimax rotation. The eigenvalues of EE and EA are equal to and greater than 1, and the result is obtained by using statistical tools with the help of SPSS 19.

Overall, 74.438% and 71.360% of variance were elucidated by these EE and EA factors, respectively, as shown in Table 8.

The factor loadings of all the items of EE and EA were found to be more than 0.5 (Hair *et al.*, 2015; Malhotra, 2002). It has been observed through analysis by SPSS 19 that the communalities values for all 19 items of EE and 21 items of EA range from 0.878 to 0.621 and 0.881 to 0.611, respectively (Table 9); hence, all the items were engaged in the questionnaire (Hair *et al.*, 2015; Malhotra, 2002).

5. Identification of factors

The three factors of EE and EA are explored and named. The naming of factors is not based on any scientific procedure but on previous literature review and expert advice has also been taken for verification (Hair *et al.*, 2015; Malhotra, 2002). The three factors in EE are awareness, enterprise knowledge and practical skills (Agarwal and Lenka, 2018; Kassean *et al.*, 2015; Kgagara, 2011; Mentoor and Friedrich, 2007). In EA, three factors are affective, behavioural and cognitive (Ede *et al.*, 1998; Lüthje and Franke, 2003; Mitchell *et al.*, 2002).

Thus, on the basis of above discussion and insights taken from literature, the following hypotheses are proposed.

H1. There is a positive effect of awareness on EA among the young community.

H2. There is a positive effect of enterprise knowledge on EA among the young community.

H3. There is a positive effect of practical skills on EA among the young community.

The factors obtained after the EFA are not providing any relative impact of EE on EA; therefore, multiple regression is used to know the relative importance and testing of hypotheses (Figure 1).

Table 7. Reliability and KMO statistics of EA

Statistics	Value
EA	
Cronbach's alpha	0.812
No. of items	21
KMO (measures of sampling adequacy)	0.66
Barlett's test of sphericity	
Chi-square	1292.03
Degree of freedom	42.00
Significance	0.000

Table 8. Eigen values and variance statistics

Factor	Eigenvalues	Percentage of variance explained	Cumulative percentage
EE			
F1	3.176	38.012	38.012
F2	2.231	28.213	66.225
F3	1.056	8.213	74.438
EA			
F1	5.231	36.215	36.215
F2	3.125	26.003	62.218
F3	1.423	9.142	71.360

SN	Items	Communalities	Factor loadings F1	F2	F3
EE					
1	The EE helps me in enterprise promotion	0.699	0.625		
2	The EE helps me in gaining knowledge about enterprise insights	0.715		0.617	
3	The EE helps me in creation of new enterprises	0.786	0.821		
4	The EE helps me in opportunity recognition	0.621	0.715		
5	The EE helps me in supply chain management	0.878			0.815
6	The EE helps me in maintaining interpersonal relationships	0.627			0.612
7	The EE helps me in financial awareness (loans, funding agencies, etc.)	0.678	0.612		
8	The EE helps me in risk tasking	0.693		0.821	
9	The EE helps me in awareness about customer needs and demands	0.759	0.811		
10	The EE helps me in enterprise management	0.712		0.711	
11	The EE helps me in new Product development	0.623			0.739
12	The EE helps me in taking initiatives	0.853			0.659
13	The EE helps me in organizing resources	0.625			0.652
14	The EE helps me in problem-solving	0.754			0.691
15	The EE helps me in networking with stakeholders	0.789			0.814
16	The EE helps me in competency development	0.836		0.709	
17	The EE helps me in idea development	0.754		0.681	
18	The EE helps me in market awareness	0.726	0.623		
19	The EE helps me in awareness about development schemes	0.715	0.719		
EA					
1	I feel enthusiastic towards entrepreneurial activities	0.699	0.792		
2	I learned various lessons from the entrepreneurial journey of entrepreneurs	0.715		0.844	
3	I am trying to improve the decision-making skills through this course	0.611		0.786	
4	I develop the positive feeling through my failures	0.814	0.661		
5	I am developing the entrepreneurial related competencies by incorporating the lessons of this course	0.623		0.531	
6	I believe that entrepreneurial knowledge is necessary to initiate an enterprise	0.698			0.758
7	I feel happy to work with innovative friends in entrepreneurial learning environment	0.715	0.687		
8	I learn the importance of networking for the success of entrepreneurial activities	0.784			0.891
9	The learning gives the idea of discovering and utilizing the opportunities from market	0.719		0.792	
10	I trust it is necessary to identify own weakness for the entrepreneurial success	0.733			0.725
11	I start asking many questions	0.819		0.625	
12	I think that competencies are necessary in this competitive business world	0.777			0.719
13	I feel excited when I give or doing any new and unusual things	0.695	0.689		

(*continued*)

Table 9. Factor loading of EE and EA

Table 9.

SN	Items	Communalities	Factor loadings F1	F2	F3
14	I listen the entrepreneurial journey of many entrepreneurs to know about their challenges	0.814		0.715	
15	I think that EE energize your curiosity habit	0.716			0.774
16	I believe that every idea has unique opportunities or prospects	0.881			0.688
17	When my answer appreciates by everyone, it develops the sense of accomplishment to me	0.874	0.796		
18	I feel to be unique to looking the problem in different ways	0.628	0.879		
19	I feel happy that my learning and hard work resulted in my activities	0.727	0.577		
20	I try to never miss any lecture of this course	0.851		0.597	
21	I actively participate and organize the entrepreneurial activities	0.739		0.531	

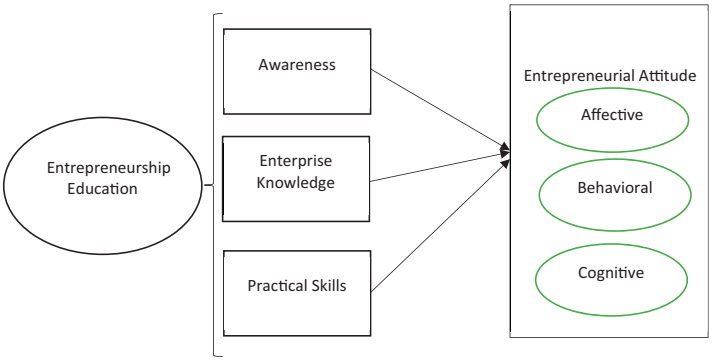

Figure 1. Framework of the study

Source: Authors

The coefficient of R^2 is 0.639, which implies that 63.09% of the variation in EA is explained by the three factors of EE that are significant (sig = 0.000, F value = 37.26). The value of adj. R^2 is 0.511, which shows that 51.10% of the total variance in EA can be explained by the regression model that is adjusted for three factors of EA. The VIF value from Table 10 for all the independent factors is less than 10, which shows that multicollinearity does not exist in the analysis (Hair *et al.*, 2015).

All the coefficients in the regression model are positive, which means all the factors of EE show the positive impact on EA (consider the composite score of three factors of EA for multiple regression analysis). Therefore, all the hypotheses are accepted.

6. Discussion and conclusion

The attitude towards entrepreneurship depends on the positive or negative personal valuation of a young community towards the entrepreneurial behaviour (Ajzen, 1991). This

positive or negative valuation is affected by the cognition level of an individual. Mitchell *et al.* (2002, p. 97) described the entrepreneurial cognition as, "the knowledge structures that people use to make assessments, judgments, or decisions involving opportunity evaluation, enterprise creation and growth". Cognition affects the thinking style, alertness and risk taking about entrepreneurial opportunities. As in entrepreneurial cognition theory, the entrepreneurial expertise approach stated that, because of the unique entrepreneurial expertise provided by EA, the future entrepreneurs develop unique information related to knowledge, process and structures of entrepreneurial activities. This study after empirical investigation also analyse that EE has a positive impact on EA. Human capital theory stated that the knowledge suggests efficient and effective ways to exploit opportunities (Byabashaija and Katono, 2011; Collins *et al.*, 2004). EE promotes entrepreneurial entry and has been visualized as the most reliable investment in human capital. During recent decades, there has been a continuous debate about EE and whether and how entrepreneurship can be taught. Pittaway and Cope (2007) stated in their study that EE had an effect on young community's enterprising affinity and intentionality. Previous studies also indicated that EE affected the attitude of young community positively and reinforced their entrepreneurial behaviour (Mentoor and Friedrich, 2007; Robinson *et al.*, 1991; Shinnar *et al.*, 2009). Our examination features the components by which EE influences innovative EA. It is imperative to recognize such components in light of the fact that information about them offers us the chance to conceptualize enterprise courses as far as what is applicable to future entrepreneurial visionaries (Rauch and Hulsink, 2015). Hence, EE and training ought to be planned in a manner that encourages the young community to build up a positive assessment of enterprises. It particularly needs to accentuate the positive parts of EE in such a way that the longing to attempt it by themselves is stirred in the young community.

7. Implications and future scope

For the educational institutes, unpredictable teaching strategies have been proposed, concentrating on associating theory and practice. Such as learning by doing and experiential learning are essential in EE for developing an EA (Henry *et al.*, 2005; Pittaway and Cope, 2007). In any case, Fayolle and Gailly (2015) contend that regardless of whether educators in the field have confidence in "learning by doing", its propriety relies upon the institutional setting of imperatives, substance and destinations with the EE. The present study is carried out with qualitative analysis; interviews have been taken of the young community that explores that EE involves dealing with a practical way such as making a business plan and investigating the surrounding market for an idea, and it strongly emphasizes on EA and personality development of them. To the best of the authors' knowledge, this is the first

Model	Unstandardized coefficient bo coefficient	Std. error	Standardized coefficient	T	Sig.	Collinearity statistics Tolerance	VIF
Constant	0.723	0.165		5.123	0.000		
Awareness	0.187	0.066	0.303	3.052	0.000	0.617	1.620
Enterprise knowledge	0.129	0.042	0.112	2.819	0.001	0.781	1.280
Practical skills	0.109	0.057	0.061	2.169	0.009	0.757	1.321

Notes: R^2 = 0.639; adj. R^2 = 0.511; sig = 0.000, F value = 37.26, dependent variable, $p < 0.01$. VIF = variance inflation factor

Table 10. Model summary and statistics

study to explore the factors of EE, such as awareness, enterprise knowledge and practical skills, and to propose the related scale. This scale can be further validated by future scholars to carry out a longitudinal study using structural equation modelling, MCDM technique, etc. Nowadays, even the corporate world expect the talented candidate from academia as an intrapreneur. An intrapreneur, also known as a corporate entrepreneur, acts as the most talented and competitive employees in a company. EE provides the young community to develop their entrepreneurial personality, which is helpful in the present uncertain environment. EE provides benefits to the government as it creates a more entrepreneurial mindset responsible for the creation of more enterprises and to the company for getting talented employees as intrapreneurs. With the assistance of EE, the government, policymakers and academicians start to build up an educational plan to develop EA among the young community through entrepreneurial learning, which is increasingly reasonable in interceding among instructive and financial prerequisites, increasingly important to the post-downturn monetary and business period and liable to be progressively viable and important for young community.

Every study has certain limitations and this study also have some such as it only considers the EE impact on EA, as EA can be affected by other variables such as family support, prior entrepreneurial and work experience, entrepreneurial resilience, etc. Future researchers can proceed by considering the impact of these factors on EA. This study is useful for the academicians and policymakers to incorporate the EE in the course curriculum to reinforce the attitude of the young community towards entrepreneurship. If we need more enterprises, we must focus on EE to generate creativity and innovation in different disciplines such as biotechnology, engineering and pharmaceuticals, which provides motivation to develop their EA and be able to create jobs and establish enterprises, as well as contribute in the socio-economic development, which is the essential need of every nation. Further studies should need to examine this relation in different contexts. EE is an exploratory procedure, or excursion, in which the worth of learning is seen through the young community, encountering and thinking about the entrepreneurial process, moving from the scholastic into the outer world in a variety of ways, genuinely and carefully. Exact and dependable frameworks are needed, which empower the instructors and young community to comprehend and investigate enterprises, showing a valuable scope of abilities, attitudes and frames of mind ought to be utilized to help the learning and doing procedure. The teachers, trainers and facilitators should be empowered, so that, they can bring a change in EE to develop a strong EA among the young community. Because if anybody is able to change the attitude of young community and strive them towards EA, it will bring drastic changes in the society, nation and the whole world. Young communities are future aspirants of any nation, and with the help of them, we change the world in a positive way.

> If the mind is intensely eager, everything can be accomplished-mountains can be crumbled into atoms.
>
> *Swami Vivekananda*

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Appendix 1. Questions used to demeanor interview from young community

1. Do you feel EE is important for the young community? Why?
2. How the idea develops?
3. How the EE prompt you towards the initiation of any entrepreneurial process?
4. Does EE effects on your attitude towards entrepreneurship?
5. Why for anyone to become an entrepreneur is important?

(Note: The rest of the questions depend on interview conversation between researchers and respondents.)

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